

The video game industry has grown to become a global phenomenon where quality and popularity are two different concepts. The objective of this project is to identify the concept of the "Quality-Popularity Gap" through analysis of whether high sales in the global market are a true indicator of quality, as viewed by users and critics alike. In a market where marketing budgets are high, some games are selling record-breaking copies despite having average reviews, while indie games are getting high ratings but are still not getting enough traction in the market. To identify this, I will use two datasets, which will help me analyze this concept further. The first dataset will be "Popular Video Games 1980-2023" available on Kaggle, which contains information on video games, their genres, release years, and ratings. The second dataset will be "Video Game Sales (vgsales)," which contains sales data for games in different regions and globally. Using Python's Pandas library, I will combine these two datasets using a left join on the "Game Title" column. The new dataset will contain 1,000 to 1,500 games with various features such as title, platform, release year, genre, global sales, and ratings.